

Crocus sativus L. (saffron) in the treatment of premenstrual syndrome: a double-blind, randomised and placebo-controlled trial.

OBJECTIVE: The aim of this double-blind and placebo-controlled trial was to investigate whether saffron (stigma of *Crocus sativus* L.) could relieve symptoms of premenstrual syndrome (PMS). **DESIGN:** Double-blind, randomised and placebo-controlled trial. **SETTING:** Departments of Gynaecology/Obstetrics and Psychiatry, Tehran and Zanzan University of Medical Sciences. **POPULATION:** Women aged 20-45 years with regular menstrual cycles and experience of PMS symptoms for at least 6 months were eligible for the study. **METHOD:** Women were randomly assigned to receive capsule saffron 30 mg/day (15 mg twice a day; morning and evening) (group A) or capsule placebo (twice a day) for a two menstrual cycles (cycles 3 and 4). **MAIN OUTCOME MEASURES:** The primary outcome measure was the Daily Symptom Report, and secondary outcome measure was the Hamilton Depression Rating Scale. **RESULTS:** In this trial, saffron was found to be effective in relieving symptoms of PMS. A significant difference was observed in efficacy of saffron in cycles 3 and 4 in the Total Premenstrual Daily Symptoms and Hamilton Depression Rating Scale. **CONCLUSION:** The results of this study indicate the efficacy of *C. sativus* L. in the treatment of PMS. However, a tolerable adverse effects profile of saffron may well confirm the application of saffron as an alternative treatment for PMS. These results deserved further investigations.